



CHAPTER XXII
SARAH ANN LUNT,
FOURTH WIFE
AND
MINING DISTRICTS
1877 – 1879

After the end of the Iron Mission, the population of Cedar City declined, but in the mid 1870's the City began to add new industries and new families were moving into the area. A new building to house The Cooperative Mercantile Institution was completed, and was dedicated by Henry Lunt on March 17, 1877.¹ This new store was welcomed by the citizens of Cedar City, as it carried a large variety of products which the settlers had not been privileged to buy in the past without going to Salt Lake City. The spirit of home manufacture was increasing among the people, but there were some things that they were just not able to make.

Henry Lunt was released as Bishop of the Cedar City Ward during church meeting on July 22, 1877. He was replaced by Christopher J. Arthur who had been a Counselor to Henry in the Bishopric.² Henry had served as Bishop for nearly twenty years and commented, "although my health is feeble, I rejoice in the Gospel and encourage the saints to try and realize that we are in the hands of the Lord." He was then sustained as President of the Stake High Priests quorum.

Joseph Fish, one of the settlers, wrote the following in his journal:

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On August 29, 1877, the wires conveyed to us sad news, notifying us of the death of President Brigham Young. This was a sad loss and especially at this particular time when the Liberals and government officials were doing all in their power to break up Mormonism and disenfranchise them. He had led the Church since the death of the Prophet Joseph Smith and had proven himself a most wonderful leader in settling this mountain region, his labors having been crowned with success. The next afternoon, Apostle Erastus Snow passed through [Cedar City] on his way to Salt Lake City to attend the funeral of the President.³

When Brigham Young died, John Taylor became acting president of the Church. He was sustained as President in October 1880.⁴

The following article concerning the happenings in Cedar City appeared in the *Deseret News* (20:711):

On November 27, 1877, the saints of Cedar City met on the site selected for the erection of a new meeting house for the purpose of laying the corner stone of said building. The ground had been broken and a number of loads of rock hauled some two years before, but, owing to the call made upon the saints to furnish labor and means to assist in the erection of the St. George Temple, the labor on the meeting house had been delayed. Bishop Arthur conducted the ceremonies. Samuel Leigh, Superintendent of the building, assisted by the Bishop, placed the stone in its proper positioning, and Counselor Jens Nielsen offered the dedicatory prayer. For a number of years past, the saints of Cedar City had been obliged to meet for services in the Social Hall which, at that time, was in a dilapidated condition and was far too small to comfortably seat the people. A public meeting was

held by the saints in the evening, at which important business was transacted. The necessity of a gristmill was strongly urged by the Bishop, and a committee appointed to labor in that interest. At this time the settlement had one of the finest cooperative sheep herds in Southern Utah. The herd had been started ten years before with about 400 head of sheep, but now there were 10,000 head of sheep in the herd. That year (1877) the shareholders of the Institution realized a fair division in lambs and, besides furnishing mutton necessary for home use, upwards of 40,000 pounds of wool had been clipped and furnished to the shareholders.

The cooperative steam sawmill which belonged to the settlement had been rented during the past two years to one of the enterprising citizens who had proved beyond contradiction that the lumber business, if properly gone into, would pay. The Mercantile and Manufacturing Institution was doing a good business, notwithstanding the scarcity of cash.

Educational matters at Cedar City at that time received special attention. There had been two Day Schools in successful operation during the summer of 1877. Quite a number of substantial dwelling houses had been erected in the settlement. The Sunday meetings were well attended and the auxiliary organizations of the settlement were doing well.

When Henry went to L.D.S. Conference in the fall of 1877, he stopped along the way and stayed with friends. At times he stayed overnight in Nephi with Edward and Harriett Lunt. On one such occasion in 1877, according to the writings of Owen and Broughton Lunt (sons of Henry and Sarah Ann), Henry dropped in to warm his hands and make repairs. He had two span of horses pulling his wagon, and the lead team had "turned short around and broke out the wagon tongue." Getting it repaired delayed his journey for hours, making it

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possible for him to spend some time there, which gave him the opportunity to get better acquainted with Edward's daughter, Sarah Ann. When Henry passed through Nephi on the way back from conference, he picked up Sarah Ann and she accompanied him to Cedar City. They were married in the St. George Temple January 16, 1878. All this was done with the consent of Sarah Ann's parents.

Sarah Ann was born in Manti, Utah, on August 1, 1858, the seventh of eight children. Sarah's father and mother joined the Church in 1851 and emigrated to America in 1856, stopping for a short time in New York and then Cincinnati before traveling on to St. Louis. While there, a son they named Moroni, was born to them. He died the same day. Their next stop was Florence, Nebraska, where they loaded two handcarts with their meager belongings. Edward and their eleven-year-old son pulled one handcart, and Harriet and her seven-year-old daughter pulled the other. The family emigrated to Utah with a group of English converts to the L.D.S. Church. They crossed the plains in the Israel Evans Company, arriving in Salt Lake City, September 1857. The approach of Johnson's army caused the evacuation of Harriet and the children to Manti and Edward joined them later. Their last move was to Nephi where they made their living farming and ranching. Sarah Ann spent a good deal of her time cooking for the workers on their ranches. Although she had little schooling, she learned many of the fine arts of sewing and knitting. Her mother had a stocking-knitting machine which would mechanically knit the legs and feet, but the toes and heels had to be made by hand. Sarah Ann became very adept at making stockings on this machine. She learned to read and write practically on her own and was able to write many letters and keep her own accounts.

When Sarah Ann married Henry Lunt, Henry had a farm which helped to supply the family and hotel patrons with fruits, vegetables and wheat for flour. They grew enough feed for the horses which had to be fed and cared for every night at the Lunt Stage Stop and Hotel. Cedar City was on the main stage line to Silver Reef, about thirty miles south of Cedar City. The stage route continued on through Southern Utah to the silver mines in Nevada. Mail as well as passengers was carried on the stage coach. The Silver Reef mine

attracted many visitors, prospectors and mining officials who traveled through Cedar City. The mine was located in a ridge of broken mountains near Leeds and came into existence in the 1870's, after silver had been discovered in a sandstone ledge. The town of Silver Reef grew to a population of fifteen hundred and was the scene of many lawless activities. This mine yielded a tremendous amount of silver while it was in operation, and brought work and revenue to Southern Utah which did much to help the economy.

According to Henry H. Lunt, a grandson of Henry, the Lunt Hotel and Stage Stop was located on First East and 100 North in Cedar City. It was constructed of native adobe brick and was a large two-story building with white trim. There was a big living room containing a fireplace, with eight rooms on the ground floor and eight upstairs (In addition, later there were more rooms built in the back). The house had a large porch. When the stage coaches pulled in, the travelers were unloaded near the porch, and the drivers took the coaches on the cobblestone driveway to the back of the building where there was a large barn and accommodations for thirty horses.

The Lunts had several adjoining lots on which they grew a large garden and a fruit orchard containing apples, peaches, plums and apricots. The home had an underground storage unit where meat, butter and milk was kept. There was also a cellar for the storage of fruits and vegetables. The family lived in the east section of the home. A belfry was on top of the building and the rope which was used to ring the bell hung through the house into the hallway. They rang the bell to call people to church, for funerals, and for other occasions.

All transportation was on unimproved roads and the travelers going through town put their horses in the hotel barn. The Stage Stop advertised with a sign on mainstreet saying that there was a "house of entertainment one block East. Good accommodations for travelers, reasonable rates, hay, grain and stabling, and there was a telegraph office located in the hotel." All the Lunt children inherited good singing voices from their parents and, undoubtedly, were part of the entertainment.

It was said that Mary Ann did most of the cooking, with the help of two dependable workers, Mary Walker and Emmeline Pendleton.⁵

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The family members helped in cooking and serving the food. All the girls and wives were involved in this part of the service to the hotel guests. There was a great deal of laundry and cleaning that was necessary to keep the rooms ready, so there was always plenty of work for everyone in the family. The boys helped care for the garden and orchard, as well as work on the farm.

On January 14, 1878, a son was born to Henry and Ann Gower Lunt. They gave him the name of Thomas Amos Lunt.

Henry and Mary Ann's older children were reaching the age where they were starting to court. Two of the sons of Thomas and Sage Treharne Jones were spending quite a lot of time at the Lunt home with Henrietta and Eva, the two oldest children. At one time, Thomas had been Henry's Counselor in the bishopric. Henrietta, the oldest, was a proficient girl who had been the first President of the Retrenchment Society (M.I.A.) when she was just seventeen years old. She went through the temple on June 23, 1873, when she was fourteen years old. Henrietta was a young girl in her teens when she first started working as a telegraph operator in the Lunt Hotel. While working in this capacity she became acquainted with Major John Wesley Powell, the man sent by the U.S. Government who solved many of the mysteries of the Green and Colorado Rivers. He successfully made a thousand-mile run down these rivers, an epic-making voyage of discovery unsurpassed in the opening of the American Frontier. He stayed at the Lunt hotel when passing through Cedar City and often sent messages by telegraph. Henrietta had this responsibility at that time and became well acquainted with Major Powell who developed a liking for her. He asked permission of Henry to give his daughter a gift, which was a beautiful cameo with matching earrings.⁶

As Patriarch, Henry gave Henrietta a blessing on February 7, 1878, and he gave a blessing to Lehi W. Jones the same day. Henrietta and Lehi were married in the St. George Temple February 13, 1878, just a month after Henry's fourth marriage. Jedediah, Lehi's younger brother, married Ellen Eva Wilson Lunt, May 21, 1878. He was twenty years old and she was seventeen. Lehi and Henrietta made their living in the cattle and sheep business while Jedediah did very well in the carpenter trade.

Apostles Erastus Snow and Wilford Woodruff were present at a conference held on March 23 and 24, 1878. At that time the Parowan Stake contained five wards--Parowan, two wards; Paragonah, one ward; Summit, one ward; and Cedar City, one ward. Kanarra had been added to the Washington Stake. The total population of these wards was about 1940 souls, of which about 500 were children under the age of eight years. William H. Dame was sustained as President of the Stake with Jesse N. Smith and Henry Lunt as his Counselors. Apostle Erastus Snow stated that this organization was to "stop contention" and was subject to any change which they might see fit to make in the future.⁷ Nine months later, on December 28, 1878, Smith was sent to Arizona, Henry took his place as First Counselor and Samuel T. Orton was sustained as Second Counselor.

The contention Apostle Snow spoke about between William H. Dame and Jessie N. Smith started in the mid 1870's. In April of 1877 President Brigham Young came to Parowan to reorganize the Stake. He released William H. Dame as President and presented as his successor, Jesse N. Smith, whom the people would not sustain. When this happened, Brigham Young did not scold the people, instead he remarked that in this Church all things are done by common consent and that church voting was not a mere formality. "The people," he said, "have exercised, today, a sacred right and your expressed wishes are to be respected. I was not aware of any difficulties here and I had no reason to anticipate the action you have taken. I am not prepared to offer another nomination now, so will ask President Dame and his Counselors to carry on until we come back at some future time." The trouble which caused the bad feelings in this situation was over irrigation water, which always seemed to be a "bone of contention."

In July of 1877 another attempt was made to reorganize the Stake by Wilford Woodruff and Erastus Snow and others who were present. The differences between William H. Dame and Jesse N. Smith were aired and still not completely settled, so they were selected as joint presidents until President Young could return and appointed a permanent president. However, President Young died in August before he could come back, and the problem was not settled. Several years elapsed before anyone came to reorganize the stake and

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dissention increased among the leading men. The people were taking sides, and a bad situation existed. To correct the troubles the First Presidency called Jesse N. Smith, who was in fact a good and very able man, to move to one of the new colonization missions in Arizona. In 1881 they sent Thomas Jefferson Jones from Washington, Utah to settle in Iron County and preside over Parowan Stake.⁸

The new President handled the situation with great wisdom and diplomacy. He moved one of his families to Parowan and another to Cedar City. He was appointed by the County Court to fill a vacancy on the board of County Selectmen, and he entered very earnestly upon his duties in both church and civil positions. He ignored, completely, the old split among the people and gathered the strong and influential men around him. One of the early projects he set for the High Council was the checking of the people's titles to their homes, lands, and water rights. They found that titles had been very loosely handled and that incorrect surveys had been made which resulted in many homes not being located on the ground described in their deeds. President Jones worked with the settlers in advising them how to correct and secure titles to their land and water. When they worked together in a common cause, the old sores healed and were forgotten. He was also a sound man on points of church doctrine.⁹

Henry and Mary Ann became grandparents on December 5, 1878 when Henrietta and Lehi W. Jones became the parents of a baby boy. They named him Thomas Willard Jones. Their second grandchild, Lamoni Lunt Jones, was born to Eva and Thomas Jones on February 16, 1879. Henry became the father of his seventeenth child when Sarah Ann had her first child, a boy, on February 5, 1879. They named him Edgerton Lunt.

In April of 1879, President Taylor was instrumental in forming an organization called "Zion's Board of Trade," which was to be a parent to local boards of trade organized by Church officials in every "Stake" or major settlement in the Utah Territory. One of the objectives of this organization was to encourage home manufacture. It was the hope of President Taylor that the initiative would be taken by each Stake or settlement to promote local industries. This was under the direction of the General Authorities of the L.D.S. Church. A year

later, a Professor from the Columbia School of Mines, John S. Newberry, visited southern Utah and was amazed at the coal and iron resources in the area. He encouraged the local officials and business leaders to patent and develop the rich store of mineral wealth.

After investigating property claims, Henry Lunt, "one of the leaders of the previous Iron Mission," conversed with President Taylor about securing patents for the Church on some coal mines and iron mines near Cedar City. The First Presidency and the twelve Apostles appropriated \$5,000 to help pay surveying and filing expenses. It was agreed that two-thirds of the property would be owned by the Church and one-third of the property would be owned by Brother Lunt.¹⁰

President Taylor thought that the proper agency to arrange for the development of these valuable properties was "Zion's Central Board of Trade." He called a special four-day conference of the central and stake boards of trade to be held in May 1881. The purpose was to arrive at a better understanding of what was needed to help develop and assist home industries, and to utilize the natural resources of the Territory. A circular was issued listing the topics to be discussed in the conference, and the first subject on the agenda was "Manufacture of Iron and Coke." The following notation was written about this:

The deposits of iron ore in Utah are said to be the largest in the world, and the manufacture of ore into iron would be the means of giving employment to hundreds of our people who, though skilled in its manipulation, are today engaged in less profitable and congenial employments. Fuel being required in large quantities, the manufacture of coke would come under this heading, being a necessity for making finer grades of iron.

An editorial was written in the *Deseret News* which stressed the fact that iron could be made in Utah and the railroad facilities were such as to "warrant not only large consumption of the invaluable

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article, but cheap and speedy transportation to the points of demand. Also, Utah is bound at some time to be a great iron-producing and iron-consuming country." The abundance of human resources for this undertaking was stressed because a large share of the Mormon emigrants were from the factory towns of England. The article pointed out that the Utah settlers were basically a manufacturing people rather than agricultural. Many came from the manufacturing and mining districts of England, Scotland, and Wales. Thousands of them were workers in the old country and scarcely any had been engaged in their native industries.

The conference held in Salt Lake City lasted two days, and the decision of the delegates was to take the necessary steps to organize a company for the manufacture of iron and coke. They planned to sell stock to raise capital to the extent of a million dollars. An iron committee was appointed by President Taylor with the approval of the delegates.¹¹ Henry Lunt was a member of the delegation and was appointed to be on the committee.

If Henry was to secure and take patents on the coal and iron land he needed to help materialize the land survey. He was listed on the General Land Office map as the "Chainman," working with James Henry Martineau who was given the contract to survey the township east of Cedar City. Several claims on iron and coal on properties around Cedar City were sent to Parowan to be recorded by William H. Dame, the Iron County Recorder. Many of the claims were signed by Henry Lunt. The iron claims situated near the mouth of Coal Creek Canyon were intended to cover the "bog" ore along the base of the "Red Hill." Some of this ore, which was very low in iron, was used in the 1850 Iron Works.¹²

Some noteworthy features on the G.L.O. Map were that the road (U-14) up Cedar Canyon ended about two miles east of the Right Hand Creek, listed on the map as "South Creek"; and the access bypassed the impassible "gorge" with a wagon road that turned south about one mile east of the Right Hand Fork. Some of the claims were named Pittsburg Iron Mine, Lunt's Iron Mine, and Mountain Queen Iron Mine, the latter being signed by Lehi Willard Jones. The high mountain east of Cedar City next to "Square Mountain" was shown

as "Mount Henry" with an elevation of 9,000 feet. At the intersection of South Creek and Coal Creek was a cabin listed as "Lunt's Rock Cabin." The Walker's Mine was in Maple Canyon and the Lunt Mine was east of the Lunt Cabin about one mile.¹³

It was recorded in the City minutes that plans for the Cedar City Iron Works were discussed. George Q. Cannon and Thomas Taylor wrote a letter to the City Council asking for ten acres of land to be appropriated for the erection of the necessary furnace and buildings for the Iron Works.¹⁴ They set aside several lots on the east side of Coal Creek for this purpose. However, the Iron Works did not materialize because of lack of capital and other more pressing matters, and the land reverted back to Cedar City.

The year of 1879 had been a year of great drought in nearly all the settlements in Utah; consequently, many settlers sustained loss of stock as well as grain and other agricultural crops. It was proposed that there should be a donation of one-thousand head of cows and five-thousand head of sheep, to be distributed among the deserving poor. The Church was to give three-thousand cows and two-thousand sheep and the balance was to be supplied by the respective Stakes of Zion, according to their means and population. The distribution was to be made under the local authorities of the respective wards and stakes. Of this number, Parowan Stake was to furnish eight cows and fifty sheep. It was stipulated by President Taylor that the cows were to be young and "good milk cows," and the sheep were to be "healthy sheep."

The drought also resulted in a scarcity of seed wheat. The Female Relief Societies of the church had been storing grain for some years for a time of emergency. It was proposed that they release the 34,761 bushels of wheat they had on hand in various parts of the Territory, and loan the wheat to the brethren who needed wheat seed for planting. The bishops in the respective districts were given the responsibility of distributing the grain and replacing it before the next harvest. During the meeting, someone from the congregation asked, "Is it to be loaned without interest?" "Why of course it is," answered President Taylor, "We don't want any nonsense of that kind, it is the time of Jubilee!"¹⁵

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1. *Deseret News*, March 1877, Salt Lake City, Utah, No. 26:142.
2. "Cedar Ward Minutes," July 22, 1877, L.D.S. Vol. 1, CR-1514-11, L.D.S. Historical Library, Salt Lake City, Utah.
3. Joseph Fish, "The Life and Times of Joseph Fish," S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah, p 171.
4. *Ibid.*
5. Zella Matheson, "Early Hotels," *Our Pioneer Heritage*, Daughters of the Utah Pioneers, Public Library, Cedar City, Utah, p. 135.
6. York and Evelyn Jones, *Lehi Willard Jones*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Woodruff Printing Company, 1972), p. 53.
7. Joseph Fish, *op. cit.*, p. 174.
8. Thomas Jefferson Jones, "Thomas J. Jones Journal," William R. Palmer File, S.U.U. Special Collections Library--Box 23, Cedar City, Utah.
9. *Ibid.*
10. *Dialogue Magazine*, Spring of 1995, p. 113.
11. Leonard J. Arrington, *Great Basin Kingdom*, (Lincoln, Nebraska: University of Nebraska Press), p. 345.
12. "Mining Location Notices, Book 'A'," Iron County Recorder's Office, County Court House, Parowan, Utah.
13. "B. L. M. Office Map File," Cedar City, Utah, General Land Office Map T-36 R10W.
14. Evelyn and York Jones, *Mayors of Cedar City*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Woodruff Printing, 1986), p. 71
15. B. H. Roberts, *The History of the L.D.S. Church*, "Drought of '79." (Salt Lake City, Utah: 1930).